



Qualification Pack

Agriculture Value Addition Consultant

QP Code: CUTM/AGR/Q0301

Version: 1.0

NSQF Level: 5

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CUTM/AGR/Q0301: Agriculture Value Addition Consultant

Brief Job Description

The individual possesses a perspective of the Agriculture Value Addition Consultant sector i.e agri-inputs, marketing, value-addition, and price analysis of the Agri output. Has requisite knowledge and skills for managerial and entrepreneurial decision making. The person can contribute to improving the livelihoods of the small producers, processors, and traders at the community level who plan to develop or expand their businesses.

Personal Attributes

An Agriculture Value Addition Consultant should be analytical, proactive, and detail-oriented with strong communication and advisory skills. They must possess a deep understanding of agri-markets, sustainability practices, and value chains. A collaborative mindset, problem-solving ability, and adaptability to rural fieldwork and digital platforms are essential for effective stakeholder engagement.

Applicable National Occupational Standards (NOS)

Compulsory NOS:

1. [CUTM/AGR/N0301: Suggest Farmers for Sustainable Seeds, Pesticides based on the Market Conditions](#)
2. [CUTM/AGR/N0302: Value Chain Developer and Analyst](#)
3. [CUTM/AGR/N0303: Study of Agri-Warehouse Operations](#)
4. [CUTM/AGR/N0304: Study and Analysis of the Formation and Operations of the Farmer Producer Organizations](#)
5. [CUTM/VSQ/N7802: Apply Health and Safety at Workplace](#)
6. [DGT/VSQ/N0102: Employability Skills \(60 Hours\)](#)

Qualification Pack (QP) Parameters

Sector	Agriculture
Sub-Sector	Sales
Occupation	Agri Sales
Country	India



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NSQF Level	5
Credits	18
Aligned to NCO/ISCO/ISIC Code	NSQF
Minimum Educational Qualification & Experience	Pursuing 2nd year of UG (Agriculture / Botany / Biology) with NA of experience OR Completed 2nd year of UG (UG Diploma) (Agriculture / Botany / Biology) with NA of experience OR Completed 3-year diploma (after 10th) (Agriculture) with 1 Year of experience OR Previous relevant Qualification of NSQF Level (4) with 3 Years of experience OR Previous relevant Qualification of NSQF Level (4.5) with 3 Years of experience
Minimum Level of Education for Training in School	
Pre-Requisite License or Training	NA
Minimum Job Entry Age	18 Years
Last Reviewed On	NA
Next Review Date	30/01/2027
NSQF Approval Date	31/01/2024
Version	1.0
Reference code on NQR	QG-05-AG-01980-2024-V1-CUTM
NQR Version	1.0

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CUTM/AGR/N0301: Suggest Farmers for Sustainable Seeds, Pesticides based on the Market Conditions

Description

This NOS focuses on helping farmers choose the right seeds and pesticides based on market demand, soil quality, and environmental impact. An expert in this role guides farmers in using sustainable and eco-friendly farming methods to improve productivity and income.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- This NOS focuses on helping farmers make smart choices about seeds and pesticides that are good for their crops, the environment, and the market. It ensures that farmers use sustainable, high-quality, and eco-friendly agricultural inputs to improve productivity and income.

Elements and Performance Criteria

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.**
 - Understand the concepts of marketing mix (Product, Price, Place, and Promotion)
- PC2.**
 - Understand the features, quality, and the use of the product (Product component of marketing mix)
- PC3.**
 - Study the pricing and payment strategies of the product (Price component of marketing mix)
- PC4.**
 - Study the locations, channels and the availability of the input (Place component of marketing mix)
- PC5.**
 - Review the promotion strategies employed to know the discounting strategy (Promotion component of marketing mix)
- PC6.** Study the different seed testing parameters – germination %, purity%
- PC7.**
 - Study the different pesticide formulations (powder, granular, liquid), and applications
- PC8.** Understand the different classes of seeds – foundation, certified
- PC9.**
 - Estimate the demand and supply and price of the inputs – based on the market trends
- PC10.**
 - Understand the government policies – laws, acts – seed acts, fertilizer and pesticide laws
- PC11.**
 - Study the secondary data (Govt portals, articles, and company websites) and prepare a market report for the inputs
- PC12.** Develop the strategy for the use of inputs based on the market trends
- PC13.** Estimate the cost of cultivation based on the crop grown, use of inputs

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

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- KU1.** global and local market trends affecting seed and pesticide choices.
- KU2.** various eco-friendly and organic farming techniques.
- KU3.** organic and bio-pesticides vs. chemical pesticides.
- KU4.** soil health management, including pH balance and nutrient levels.
- KU5.** to conduct training sessions and awareness programs
- KU6.** value addition techniques to increase profitability.
- KU7.** global and local market trends affecting seed and pesticide choices.
- KU8.** pesticide residue management and its impact on soil and crops.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Ability to explain complex agricultural concepts in simple language to farmers.
- GS2.** Ability to build relationships with farmers, suppliers, and government bodies
- GS3.** Leadership skills to conduct training, awareness programs, and field demonstrations.
- GS4.** Ability to analyze soil health, climate conditions, and market trends to make informed recommendations.
- GS5.** Understanding various seed types (hybrid, genetically modified, drought-resistant, organic).
- GS6.** Awareness of chemical vs. bio-pesticides and their environmental impact.
- GS7.** Ability to analyze soil test reports and suggest appropriate seed varieties and nutrients.
- GS8.** Guiding farmers on sustainable agricultural practices and financial planning.

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
	30	40	-	30
PC1. • Understand the concepts of marketing mix (Product, Price, Place, and • Promotion)	5	4	-	1
PC2. • Understand the features, quality, and the use of the product (Product • component of marketing mix)	3	3	-	3
PC3. • Study the pricing and payment strategies of the product (Price component of • marketing mix)	3	3	-	4
PC4. • Study the locations, channels and the availability of the input (Place • component of marketing mix)	3	2	-	1
PC5. • Review the promotion strategies employed to know the discounting strategy • (Promotion component of marketing mix)	3	3	-	3
PC6. Study the different seed testing parameters - germination %, purity%	2	2	-	3
PC7. • Study the different pesticide formulations (powder, granular, liquid), and • applications	1	2	-	1
PC8. Understand the different classes of seeds - foundation, certified	2	4	-	1
PC9. • Estimate the demand and supply and price of the inputs - based on the • market trends	2	5	-	2
PC10. • Understand the government policies - laws, acts - seed acts, fertilizer and • pesticide laws	2	5	-	1

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC11. - Study the secondary data (Govt portals, articles, and company websites) and - prepare a market report for the inputs	2	5	-	4
PC12. Develop the strategy for the use of inputs based on the market trends	1	1	-	3
PC13. Estimate the cost of cultivation based on the crop grown, use of inputs	1	1	-	3
NOS Total	30	40	-	30



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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	CUTM/AGR/N0301
NOS Name	Suggest Farmers for Sustainable Seeds, Pesticides based on the Market Conditions
Sector	Agriculture
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Agri Sales
NSQF Level	5
Credits	3
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	31/01/2024
Next Review Date	30/01/2027
NSQC Clearance Date	31/01/2024

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CUTM/AGR/N0302: Value Chain Developer and Analyst

Description

This NOs focuses on analyzing agricultural value chains to improve efficiency, sustainability, and market competitiveness. It involves identifying value addition opportunities, optimizing post-harvest processes, enhancing supply chain logistics, and conducting market research. Professionals in this role help farmers, agribusinesses, and stakeholders maximize profitability by implementing innovative strategies, financial planning, and sustainable practices while ensuring compliance with industry regulations and quality standards.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- This NOS includes analyzing market trends, improving post-harvest management, enhancing supply chain efficiency, and identifying value addition opportunities. The scope also involves integrating technology, ensuring sustainability, and complying with regulatory standards. Professionals in this role work with farmers, agribusinesses, and stakeholders to strengthen market linkages, reduce losses, and maximize profitability in the agricultural sector.

Elements and Performance Criteria

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Study the characteristics of agri-food markets and impact on small farmers
- PC2.** Understand the Porter's model of value chain and competitive advantage in the context of the value chain
- PC3.** Study the value chain implications to producers (farmers), traders, processors, wholesalers, and retailers
- PC4.** Study and analyze the credit sources for small and marginal farmers
- PC5.** Understand the credit barriers for the small and marginal farmers
- PC6.** Review the characteristics and challenges of the Indian Agri food value chains for various commodities/products
- PC7.** Understand the role of consumers, local bodies, NGO's, in the food value chain – community involvement for market linkages
- PC8.** Review the national and international policies – laws, acts affecting the value chains
- PC9.** Study the trends in the agricultural value chains – consolidation, vertical integration – review examples of industry consolidation in various sectors – agri inputs, processing, and retailing
- PC10.** Prepare a SWOT (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats) analysis report of the value chains (commodities, processed products)
- PC11.** Develop a sustainable food value chain framework for the community

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:



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- KU1.** the agricultural value chain, from production to consumption.
- KU2.** Methods for analyzing market trends, demand, and supply chain dynamics.
- KU3.** quality standards and certifications in value-added products.
- KU4.** agricultural subsidies, incentives, and policies related to value chain development.
- KU5.** Principles of sustainable agriculture and eco-friendly practices.
- KU6.** Skills for interacting with farmers, processors, traders, and policymakers.
- KU7.** Price fluctuations and their impact on different value chain stages.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Ability to clearly explain value chain concepts to farmers, traders, and stakeholders.
- GS2.** Working with farmers, agribusinesses, policymakers, and financial institutions.
- GS3.** Effectively dealing with suppliers, buyers, and financial institutions to ensure profitable agreements.
- GS4.** Identifying business opportunities and innovative solutions in agricultural value addition.
- GS5.** Conducting cost-benefit analysis, investment planning, and financial modeling.
- GS6.** Using digital tools, data analytics, and e-commerce platforms for value chain development.
- GS7.** Promoting eco-friendly processing, packaging, and waste management.

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
	40	60	-	-
PC1. Study the characteristics of agri-food markets and impact on small farmers	4	6	-	-
PC2. Understand the Porter's model of value chain and competitive advantage in the context of the value chain	3	6	-	-
PC3. Study the value chain implications to producers (farmers), traders, processors, wholesalers, and retailers	3	6	-	-
PC4. Study and analyze the credit sources for small and marginal farmers	5	6	-	-
PC5. Understand the credit barriers for the small and marginal farmers	5	5	-	-
PC6. Review the characteristics and challenges of the Indian Agri food value chains for various commodities/products	5	5	-	-
PC7. Understand the role of consumers, local bodies, NGO's, in the food value chain – community involvement for market linkages	5	6	-	-
PC8. Review the national and international policies – laws, acts affecting the value chains	3	5	-	-
PC9. Study the trends in the agricultural value chains – consolidation, vertical integration – review examples of industry consolidation in various sectors – agri inputs, processing, and retailing	4	6	-	-
PC10. Prepare a SWOT (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats) analysis report of the value chains (commodities, processed products)	2	5	-	-
PC11. Develop a sustainable food value chain framework for the community	1	4	-	-
NOS Total	40	60	-	-



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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	CUTM/AGR/N0302
NOS Name	Value Chain Developer and Analyst
Sector	Agriculture
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Agri Sales
NSQF Level	5
Credits	4
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	31/01/2024
Next Review Date	30/01/2027
NSQC Clearance Date	31/01/2024

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CUTM/AGR/N0303: Study of Agri-Warehouse Operations

Description

This nos focuses on the efficient management of agricultural warehouses. It covers key aspects such as storage techniques, inventory management, quality control, logistics, and regulatory compliance. Professionals in this role ensure the safe handling, preservation, and distribution of agricultural commodities, reducing post-harvest losses. They also implement modern technologies, risk management strategies, and financial planning to enhance warehouse efficiency and support a sustainable agricultural supply chain.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- This nos covers the management of agricultural storage facilities to ensure efficient handling, preservation, and distribution of commodities. The scope includes inventory control, quality assurance, warehouse logistics, risk management, and regulatory compliance. It also involves the adoption of modern storage technologies, sustainable practices, and financial planning for warehouse operations. Professionals in this field play a crucial role in minimizing post-harvest losses, improving supply chain efficiency, and supporting farmers with better market access.

Elements and Performance Criteria

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Review the need of a warehouse/s and understand the requirements for establishing a warehouse
- PC2.** Study the types and functions of public warehouses
- PC3.** Study the types and functions of private warehouses
- PC4.** Study the types and functions of government warehouses
- PC5.** Study the types and functions of cooperative warehouses
- PC6.** Study the cold storage warehouses
- PC7.** Study the operations of climate controlled warehouses
- PC8.** Study the operations of export and import related warehouses
- PC9.** Study the operations of the field warehouses
- PC10.** Study the operations of the agricultural warehouses
- PC11.**
 - Prepare a report on the storage structure and stack plan of the
 - warehouse
- PC12.** Review the availability of the lab facilities and types of tests conducted like grading
- PC13.** Study the risks associated with agri warehouses
- PC14.** Review the safety, security and firefighting measures of the warehouse
- PC15.** Understand the link with an NABL accredited laboratory
- PC16.** Understand the insurance products available for mitigating the risks

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- PC17.** Review the details of the registration of the warehouse – WDRA – (Warehousing Development and Regulatory Authority)
- PC18.** Study the e-NWR repository – provisions, services
- PC19.** Study the quality parameters for storing the different categories of goods – commodities, processed/finished products
- PC20.** Review the drying methods in the warehouse
- PC21.** Review the pest control measures
- PC22.** Understand the frequency of quality checks
- PC23.** Study the prophylactic treatments used – know the types of chemicals used, frequency, dosage and method of application
- PC24.** Review the fumigation protocols – fumigant used, frequency of application, dosage
- PC25.** Study the importance of dunnage
- PC26.** Understand the reasons for the use of specific dunnage – plastic sheet, husk, wooden crates
- PC27.** Review the details of the chemical inventory
- PC28.** Study the steps involved in receiving the stock at the warehouse
- PC29.** Study the role of different stakeholders involved in the warehouse – logistics, insurance, assaying lab, bank, fire services, FSSAI, police, labour
- PC30.** Study the details of the facilities available for weighing of the stocks – type of equipment, number and make, and status of stamping by the legal metrology department
- PC31.** Study the procedure followed for stock verification in the warehouse
- PC32.** Study the details of the Warehouse Management Software (WMS) – Name of service provider, version cost, features, and benefits of WMS
- PC33.** Study the list of documents maintained for receiving the stock
- PC34.** Study the list of documents maintained for delivery of goods

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** the role and importance of warehouses in agriculture.
- KU2.** Scientific methods of storing grains, fruits, vegetables, and perishable goods.
- KU3.** Knowledge of storage structures, silos, cold storage, and ventilation systems.
- KU4.** warehouse management software (WMS) for tracking and reporting.
- KU5.** Standard operating procedures (SOPs) for grading and packaging.
- KU6.** Logistics planning for efficient storage and distribution.
- KU7.** government policies, FSSAI, APMC, and Warehousing (Development & Regulation) Act.
- KU8.** Green warehousing solutions such as solar-powered storage and biodegradable packaging.
- KU9.** Waste management and recycling techniques.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:



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- GS1.** Identify and addressing issues related to storage, inventory management, and logistics.
- GS2.** Make quick and informed decisions on stock handling, risk mitigation, and resource allocation.
- GS3.** Stay updated with new storage technologies, government regulations, and market trends.
- GS4.** Understand inventory calculations, stock valuation, and financial reports.
- GS5.** do stacking, grading, packaging, and distribution of agricultural commodities.
- GS6.** Maintain records using Warehouse Management Systems (WMS) and tracking stock movement.
- GS7.** Understand and following legal requirements, food safety norms, and government policies.
- GS8.** Manage operational costs, budgeting, and knowledge of Warehouse Receipt Financing.
- GS9.** Use IoT sensors, barcode scanning, and automation for efficient warehouse monitoring.

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
	40	60	-	-
PC1. Review the need of a warehouse/s and understand the requirements for establishing a warehouse	1	2	-	-
PC2. Study the types and functions of public warehouses	1	2	-	-
PC3. Study the types and functions of private warehouses	1	2	-	-
PC4. Study the types and functions of government warehouses	1	2	-	-
PC5. Study the types and functions of cooperative warehouses	1	2	-	-
PC6. Study the cold storage warehouses	1	2	-	-
PC7. Study the operations of climate controlled warehouses	1	2	-	-
PC8. Study the operations of export and import related warehouses	1	2	-	-
PC9. Study the operations of the field warehouses	1	2	-	-
PC10. Study the operations of the agricultural warehouses	1	2	-	-
PC11. • Prepare a report on the storage structure and stack plan of the • warehouse	1	2	-	-
PC12. Review the availability of the lab facilities and types of tests conducted like grading	1	2	-	-
PC13. Study the risks associated with agri warehouses	1	2	-	-
PC14. Review the safety, security and firefighting measures of the warehouse	1	2	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC15. Understand the link with an NABL accredited laboratory	1	2	-	-
PC16. Understand the insurance products available for mitigating the risks	1	2	-	-
PC17. Review the details of the registration of the warehouse – WDRA – (Warehousing Development and Regulatory Authority)	1	2	-	-
PC18. Study the e-NWR repository – provisions, services	1	2	-	-
PC19. Study the quality parameters for storing the different categories of goods – commodities, processed/finished products	1	2	-	-
PC20. Review the drying methods in the warehouse	1	2	-	-
PC21. Review the pest control measures	3	2	-	-
PC22. Understand the frequency of quality checks	1	2	-	-
PC23. Study the prophylactic treatments used – know the types of chemicals used, frequency, dosage and method of application	3	2	-	-
PC24. Review the fumigation protocols – fumigant used, frequency of application, dosage	1	3	-	-
PC25. Study the importance of dunnage	1	2	-	-
PC26. Understand the reasons for the use of specific dunnage – plastic sheet, husk, wooden crates	1	1	-	-
PC27. Review the details of the chemical inventory	1	1	-	-
PC28. Study the steps involved in receiving the stock at the warehouse	1	1	-	-
PC29. Study the role of different stakeholders involved in the warehouse – logistics, insurance, assaying lab, bank, fire services, FSSAI, police, labour	1	1	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC30. Study the details of the facilities available for weighing of the stocks – type of equipment, number and make, and status of stamping by the legal metrology department	1	1	-	-
PC31. Study the procedure followed for stock verification in the warehouse	1	1	-	-
PC32. Study the details of the Warehouse Management Software (WMS) – Name of service provider, version cost, features, and benefits of WMS	1	1	-	-
PC33. Study the list of documents maintained for receiving the stock	2	1	-	-
PC34. Study the list of documents maintained for delivery of goods	2	1	-	-
NOS Total	40	60	-	-



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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	CUTM/AGR/N0303
NOS Name	Study of Agri-Warehouse Operations
Sector	Agriculture
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Agri Sales
NSQF Level	5
Credits	3
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	31/01/2024
Next Review Date	30/01/2027
NSQF Clearance Date	31/01/2024

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CUTM/AGR/N0304: Study and Analysis of the Formation and Operations of the Farmer Producer Organizations

Description

This NOS focuses on focuses on the establishment, governance, and management of FPOs. It covers legal frameworks, financial planning, market linkages, and supply chain management. Professionals in this role help farmers organize, access funding, improve productivity, and enhance market competitiveness. The NOS also emphasizes risk management, digital integration, and sustainable business strategies to ensure the long-term success of FPOs.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- This NOS focuses on focuses on empowering farmers through collective business models. The scope includes FPO registration, governance, financial planning, market linkages, and supply chain management. It also covers government policies, risk management, digital tools, and sustainable agricultural practices.

Elements and Performance Criteria

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Understand the concepts of FPG (Farmer Producer Groups)
- PC2.** Understand the concepts of FPO (Farmer Producer Organizations)
- PC3.** Study the FPO act provisions
- PC4.** Study the regulation instruments
- PC5.** Understand the formation and functioning (management and governance) of an FPG/FPO
- PC6.** Study the micro-plan preparation and enterprise opportunities
- PC7.** Understand the grant funds available for FPO's
- PC8.** Develop the business plan for an FPO
- PC9.** Develop the market strategy for the FPO
- PC10.** .Develop the operational strategy for the FPO
- PC11.** Calculate and interpret the net sales of the FPO
- PC12.** Calculate the gross profit ratio
- PC13.** Calculate the net profit ratio
- PC14.** Calculate the debt service ratio
- PC15.** Calculate the internal rate of return
- PC16.** Calculate the current ratio
- PC17.** Calculate the breakeven sales
- PC18.** Calculate the Inventory turnover ratio
- PC19.** Develop the productive enhancement strategies for agricultural, horticultural crops
- PC20.** Study and analyze the value chain for the commodities/products

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- PC21.** Analyze the market linkages
- PC22.** Develop different models of agribusiness promotion through promotion
- PC23.** Understand the challenges of the FPO's in the areas of capacity building, operations, credit availability, lack of knowledge (business, market linkages)
- PC24.** Understand the national policies – laws, acts affecting the value chains, govt schemes available for agribusiness promotion
- PC25.** Study the other agri based enterprises – livestock based value chain development, scope and potentiality of agribusiness in livestock sector
- PC26.** Review the National Horticulture mission, models of horticulture based FPO's, technology transfer and marketing

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** Differences between FPOs, cooperatives, and self-help groups (SHGs).
- KU2.** Process of FPO registration under relevant laws (Companies Act, Cooperative Societies Act, etc.).
- KU3.** Responsibilities of FPO leadership and decision-making processes.
- KU4.** capital requirements, shareholding, and investment structures.
- KU5.** Strategies for collective marketing, contract farming, and direct selling.
- KU6.** Managing risks related to market fluctuations, climate change, and credit defaults.
- KU7.** Compliance with food safety, trade regulations, and government mandates.
- KU8.** Role of mobile apps, and smart contracts in FPO operations.
- KU9.** Contribution of FPOs to farmer income enhancement and rural development.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** effectively interact with farmers, stakeholders, and policymakers.
- GS2.** Guide FPO members in decision-making and fostering collaboration.
- GS3.** Build partnerships with buyers, suppliers, and financial institutions.
- GS4.** Prioritize and organize tasks efficiently for smooth FPO operations.
- GS5.** Understand financial data, budgets, and market reports.
- GS6.** do budgeting, profit distribution, funding sources, and financial record-keeping.
- GS7.** Use digital tools for business transactions, record-keeping, and marketing.
- GS8.** Promote eco-friendly farming, improving livelihoods, and enhancing rural development.
- GS9.** Manage procurement, storage, distribution, and transportation of agricultural produce.

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
	30	70	-	-
PC1. Understand the concepts of FPG (Farmer Producer Groups)	1	1	-	-
PC2. Understand the concepts of FPO (Farmer Producer Organizations)	2	1	-	-
PC3. Study the FPO act provisions	1	1	-	-
PC4. Study the regulation instruments	1	2	-	-
PC5. Understand the formation and functioning (management and governance) of an FPG/FPO	1	2	-	-
PC6. Study the micro-plan preparation and enterprise opportunities	1	2	-	-
PC7. Understand the grant funds available for FPO's	1	3	-	-
PC8. Develop the business plan for an FPO	1	3	-	-
PC9. Develop the market strategy for the FPO	1	4	-	-
PC10. Develop the operational strategy for the FPO	1	3	-	-
PC11. Calculate and interpret the net sales of the FPO	1	3	-	-
PC12. Calculate the gross profit ratio	1	4	-	-
PC13. Calculate the net profit ratio	1	4	-	-
PC14. Calculate the debt service ratio	1	5	-	-
PC15. Calculate the internal rate of return	1	6	-	-
PC16. Calculate the current ratio	1	5	-	-
PC17. Calculate the breakeven sales	1	5	-	-
PC18. Calculate the Inventory turnover ratio	1	4	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC19. Develop the productive enhancement strategies for agricultural, horticultural crops	1	5	-	-
PC20. Study and analyze the value chain for the commodities/products	1	1	-	-
PC21. Analyze the market linkages	1	1	-	-
PC22. Develop different models of agribusiness promotion through promotion	1	1	-	-
PC23. Understand the challenges of the FPO's in the areas of capacity building, operations, credit availability, lack of knowledge (business, market linkages)	1	1	-	-
PC24. Understand the national policies – laws, acts affecting the value chains, govt schemes available for agribusiness promotion	1	1	-	-
PC25. Study the other agri based enterprises – livestock based value chain development, scope and potentiality of agribusiness in livestock sector	1	1	-	-
PC26. Review the National Horticulture mission, models of horticulture based FPO's, technology transfer and marketing	4	1	-	-
NOS Total	30	70	-	-



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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	CUTM/AGR/N0304
NOS Name	Study and Analysis of the Formation and Operations of the Farmer Producer Organizations
Sector	Agriculture
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Agri Sales
NSQF Level	5
Credits	3
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	31/01/2024
Next Review Date	30/01/2027
NSQC Clearance Date	31/01/2024

Qualification Pack

CUTM/VSQ/N7802: Apply Health and Safety at Workplace

Description

This NOS pertains to ensuring a safe, hazard-free work environment by performing safety checks, using PPE, understanding chemical hazards, and responding to emergencies. It also includes handling first aid, waste disposal, risk assessment, and documenting safety incidents and market data as per workplace protocols.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- The scope of this NOS includes practicing safety measures in day-to-day operations, preventing accidents, using and maintaining emergency and safety equipment, and following emergency response procedures. It also covers first aid administration, proper documentation, and handling hazardous materials responsibly to maintain workplace health and safety standards.

Elements and Performance Criteria

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Undertaking basic safety checks before operation of all machinery and vehicles and hazards are reported to the appropriate supervisor.
- PC2.** Work for which protective clothing or equipment is required is identified and the appropriate protective clothing or equipment is used in performing these duties in accordance with workplace policy.
- PC3.** Reading and understanding the hazards of use and contamination mentioned on the labels of pesticides/fumigants etc
- PC4.** Assessing the risks prior to performing manual handling jobs and work according to currently recommended safe practice.
- PC5.** Use equipment and materials safely and correctly and return the same to designated storage when not in use.
- PC6.** Dispose of waste safely and correctly in a designated area.
- PC7.** Recognize risks to bystanders and take action to reduce risk associated with jobs in the workplace.
- PC8.** Perform your work in a manner which minimizes environmental damage all procedures and work instructions for controlling risk are followed closely.
- PC9.** Report any accidents, incidents or problems without delay to an appropriate person and take necessary immediate action to reduce further danger.
- PC10.** Follow procedures for dealing with accidents, fires and emergencies, including communicating location and directions to emergency.
- PC11.** Follow emergency procedures to company standard / workplace requirements.
- PC12.** Ascertain availability and non-availability of specific market information.
- PC13.** Perform documentation for analyzing market information.
- PC14.** Evaluate the authenticity of information received.

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- PC15.** Analyze the information for taking decision.
- PC16.** Use emergency equipment in accordance with manufacturers' specifications and workplace requirements.
- PC17.** Provide treatment appropriate to the patient's injuries in accordance with recognized first aid techniques.
- PC18.** Recover (if practical), clean, inspect/test, refurbish, replace and store the first aid equipment as appropriate.
- PC19.** Details report of first aid administered in accordance with workplace procedures.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** basic safety protocols for machinery and vehicle operation in agricultural or industrial settings.
- KU2.** the types of personal protective equipment (PPE) required for specific tasks and their correct usage.
- KU3.** hazard symbols and labels, particularly on chemicals like pesticides or fumigants.
- KU4.** the manuals handling risks and apply appropriate ergonomic principles to reduce injury.
- KU5.** the procedures for safe use and storage of tools, equipment, and materials.
- KU6.** waste disposal protocols as per environmental and workplace guidelines.
- KU7.** potential hazards to coworkers and bystanders, and know mitigation strategies.
- KU8.** emergency procedures, including fire safety, accident response, and first aid.
- KU9.** documentation processes for safety and market information.
- KU10.** evaluate, verify, and use market and safety information for decision-making.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Perform safety checks independently and communicate hazards effectively to supervisors.
- GS2.** Use and maintain equipment responsibly, ensuring safety and longevity.
- GS3.** Demonstrate the ability to follow written and verbal instructions related to hazardous materials.
- GS4.** Apply decision-making skills in risk assessment and emergency scenarios.
- GS5.** Communicate clearly during emergencies, including providing accurate directions.
- GS6.** Execute emergency treatment using recognized first aid techniques.
- GS7.** Maintain accurate and timely documentation for safety incidents and market-related data.
- GS8.** Handle emergency equipment confidently, adhering to operational protocols.
- GS9.** Evaluate and interpret workplace data for taking informed decisions.
- GS10.** Exhibit responsibility and environmental awareness in performing daily tasks.

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
	30	40	-	30
PC1. Undertaking basic safety checks before operation of all machinery and vehicles and hazards are reported to the appropriate supervisor.	2	3	-	2
PC2. Work for which protective clothing or equipment is required is identified and the appropriate protective clothing or equipment is used in performing these duties in accordance with workplace policy.	2	3	-	2
PC3. Reading and understanding the hazards of use and contamination mentioned on the labels of pesticides/fumigants etc	2	3	-	2
PC4. Assessing the risks prior to performing manual handling jobs and work according to currently recommended safe practice.	2	3	-	2
PC5. Use equipment and materials safely and correctly and return the same to designated storage when not in use.	2	3	-	2
PC6. Dispose of waste safely and correctly in a designated area.	-	3	-	-
PC7. Recognize risks to bystanders and take action to reduce risk associated with jobs in the workplace.	2	3	-	2
PC8. Perform your work in a manner which minimizes environmental damage all procedures and work instructions for controlling risk are followed closely.	2	3	-	2
PC9. Report any accidents, incidents or problems without delay to an appropriate person and take necessary immediate action to reduce further danger.	2	3	-	2
PC10. Follow procedures for dealing with accidents, fires and emergencies, including communicating location and directions to emergency.	2	3	-	2

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC11. Follow emergency procedures to company standard / workplace requirements.	2	1	-	2
PC12. Ascertain availability and non-availability of specific market information.	2	1	-	2
PC13. Perform documentation for analyzing market information.	2	1	-	2
PC14. Evaluate the authenticity of information received.	-	1	-	-
PC15. Analyze the information for taking decision.	2	1	-	2
PC16. Use emergency equipment in accordance with manufacturers' specifications and workplace requirements.	2	1	-	2
PC17. Provide treatment appropriate to the patient's injuries in accordance with recognized first aid techniques.	2	1	-	2
PC18. Recover (if practical), clean, inspect/test, refurbish, replace and store the first aid equipment as appropriate.	-	1	-	-
PC19. Details report of first aid administered in accordance with workplace procedures.	-	2	-	-
NOS Total	30	40	-	30



Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	CUTM/VSQ/N7802
NOS Name	Apply Health and Safety at Workplace
Sector	Cross Sectoral
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Health and Safety
NSQF Level	4
Credits	3
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	22/10/2024
Next Review Date	22/10/2027
NSQC Clearance Date	22/10/2024



Qualification Pack

DGT/VSQ/N0102: Employability Skills (60 Hours)

Description

This unit is about employability skills, Constitutional values, becoming a professional in the 21st Century, digital, financial, and legal literacy, diversity and Inclusion, English and communication skills, customer service, entrepreneurship, and apprenticeship, getting ready for jobs and career development.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Introduction to Employability Skills
- Constitutional values - Citizenship
- Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century
- Basic English Skills
- Career Development & Goal Setting
- Communication Skills
- Diversity & Inclusion
- Financial and Legal Literacy
- Essential Digital Skills
- Entrepreneurship
- Customer Service
- Getting ready for Apprenticeship & Jobs

Elements and Performance Criteria

Introduction to Employability Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** identify employability skills required for jobs in various industries
- PC2.** identify and explore learning and employability portals

Constitutional values – Citizenship

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC3.** recognize the significance of constitutional values, including civic rights and duties, citizenship, responsibility towards society etc. and personal values and ethics such as honesty, integrity, caring and respecting others, etc.
- PC4.** follow environmentally sustainable practices

Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC5.** recognize the significance of 21st Century Skills for employment
- PC6.** practice the 21st Century Skills such as Self-Awareness, Behaviour Skills, time management, critical and adaptive thinking, problem-solving, creative thinking, social and cultural awareness, emotional awareness, learning to learn for continuous learning etc. in personal and professional life

Basic English Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

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- PC7.** use basic English for everyday conversation in different contexts, in person and over the telephone
- PC8.** read and understand routine information, notes, instructions, mails, letters etc. written in English
- PC9.** write short messages, notes, letters, e-mails etc. in English

Career Development & Goal Setting

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC10.** understand the difference between job and career
- PC11.** prepare a career development plan with short- and long-term goals, based on aptitude

Communication Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC12.** follow verbal and non-verbal communication etiquette and active listening techniques in various settings
- PC13.** work collaboratively with others in a team

Diversity & Inclusion

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC14.** communicate and behave appropriately with all genders and PwD
- PC15.** escalate any issues related to sexual harassment at workplace according to POSH Act

Financial and Legal Literacy

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC16.** select financial institutions, products and services as per requirement
- PC17.** carry out offline and online financial transactions, safely and securely
- PC18.** identify common components of salary and compute income, expenses, taxes, investments etc
- PC19.** identify relevant rights and laws and use legal aids to fight against legal exploitation

Essential Digital Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC20.** operate digital devices and carry out basic internet operations securely and safely
- PC21.** use e- mail and social media platforms and virtual collaboration tools to work effectively
- PC22.** use basic features of word processor, spreadsheets, and presentations

Entrepreneurship

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC23.** identify different types of Entrepreneurship and Enterprises and assess opportunities for potential business through research
- PC24.** develop a business plan and a work model, considering the 4Ps of Marketing Product, Price, Place and Promotion
- PC25.** identify sources of funding, anticipate, and mitigate any financial/ legal hurdles for the potential business opportunity

Customer Service

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC26.** identify different types of customers
- PC27.** identify and respond to customer requests and needs in a professional manner.

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PC28. follow appropriate hygiene and grooming standards

Getting ready for apprenticeship & Jobs

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC29. create a professional Curriculum vitae (Résumé)

PC30. search for suitable jobs using reliable offline and online sources such as Employment exchange, recruitment agencies, newspapers etc. and job portals, respectively

PC31. apply to identified job openings using offline /online methods as per requirement

PC32. answer questions politely, with clarity and confidence, during recruitment and selection

PC33. identify apprenticeship opportunities and register for it as per guidelines and requirements

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

KU1. need for employability skills and different learning and employability related portals

KU2. various constitutional and personal values

KU3. different environmentally sustainable practices and their importance

KU4. Twenty first (21st) century skills and their importance

KU5. how to use English language for effective verbal (face to face and telephonic) and written communication in formal and informal set up

KU6. importance of career development and setting long- and short-term goals

KU7. about effective communication

KU8. POSH Act

KU9. Gender sensitivity and inclusivity

KU10. different types of financial institutes, products, and services

KU11. how to compute income and expenditure

KU12. importance of maintaining safety and security in offline and online financial transactions

KU13. different legal rights and laws

KU14. different types of digital devices and the procedure to operate them safely and securely

KU15. how to create and operate an e- mail account and use applications such as word processors, spreadsheets etc.

KU16. how to identify business opportunities

KU17. types and needs of customers

KU18. how to apply for a job and prepare for an interview

KU19. apprenticeship scheme and the process of registering on apprenticeship portal

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

GS1. read and write different types of documents/instructions/correspondence

GS2. communicate effectively using appropriate language in formal and informal settings



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- GS3.** behave politely and appropriately with all
- GS4.** how to work in a virtual mode
- GS5.** perform calculations efficiently
- GS6.** solve problems effectively
- GS7.** pay attention to details
- GS8.** manage time efficiently
- GS9.** maintain hygiene and sanitization to avoid infection

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Introduction to Employability Skills</i>	1	1	-	-
PC1. identify employability skills required for jobs in various industries	-	-	-	-
PC2. identify and explore learning and employability portals	-	-	-	-
<i>Constitutional values – Citizenship</i>	1	1	-	-
PC3. recognize the significance of constitutional values, including civic rights and duties, citizenship, responsibility towards society etc. and personal values and ethics such as honesty, integrity, caring and respecting others, etc.	-	-	-	-
PC4. follow environmentally sustainable practices	-	-	-	-
<i>Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century</i>	2	4	-	-
PC5. recognize the significance of 21st Century Skills for employment	-	-	-	-
PC6. practice the 21st Century Skills such as Self-Awareness, Behaviour Skills, time management, critical and adaptive thinking, problem-solving, creative thinking, social and cultural awareness, emotional awareness, learning to learn for continuous learning etc. in personal and professional life	-	-	-	-
<i>Basic English Skills</i>	2	3	-	-
PC7. use basic English for everyday conversation in different contexts, in person and over the telephone	-	-	-	-
PC8. read and understand routine information, notes, instructions, mails, letters etc. written in English	-	-	-	-
PC9. write short messages, notes, letters, e-mails etc. in English	-	-	-	-
<i>Career Development & Goal Setting</i>	1	2	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC10. understand the difference between job and career	-	-	-	-
PC11. prepare a career development plan with short- and long-term goals, based on aptitude	-	-	-	-
<i>Communication Skills</i>	2	2	-	-
PC12. follow verbal and non-verbal communication etiquette and active listening techniques in various settings	-	-	-	-
PC13. work collaboratively with others in a team	-	-	-	-
<i>Diversity & Inclusion</i>	1	2	-	-
PC14. communicate and behave appropriately with all genders and PwD	-	-	-	-
PC15. escalate any issues related to sexual harassment at workplace according to POSH Act	-	-	-	-
<i>Financial and Legal Literacy</i>	2	3	-	-
PC16. select financial institutions, products and services as per requirement	-	-	-	-
PC17. carry out offline and online financial transactions, safely and securely	-	-	-	-
PC18. identify common components of salary and compute income, expenses, taxes, investments etc	-	-	-	-
PC19. identify relevant rights and laws and use legal aids to fight against legal exploitation	-	-	-	-
<i>Essential Digital Skills</i>	3	4	-	-
PC20. operate digital devices and carry out basic internet operations securely and safely	-	-	-	-
PC21. use e- mail and social media platforms and virtual collaboration tools to work effectively	-	-	-	-
PC22. use basic features of word processor, spreadsheets, and presentations	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Entrepreneurship</i>	2	3	-	-
PC23. identify different types of Entrepreneurship and Enterprises and assess opportunities for potential business through research	-	-	-	-
PC24. develop a business plan and a work model, considering the 4Ps of Marketing Product, Price, Place and Promotion	-	-	-	-
PC25. identify sources of funding, anticipate, and mitigate any financial/ legal hurdles for the potential business opportunity	-	-	-	-
<i>Customer Service</i>	1	2	-	-
PC26. identify different types of customers	-	-	-	-
PC27. identify and respond to customer requests and needs in a professional manner.	-	-	-	-
PC28. follow appropriate hygiene and grooming standards	-	-	-	-
<i>Getting ready for apprenticeship & Jobs</i>	2	3	-	-
PC29. create a professional Curriculum vitae (Résumé)	-	-	-	-
PC30. search for suitable jobs using reliable offline and online sources such as Employment exchange, recruitment agencies, newspapers etc. and job portals, respectively	-	-	-	-
PC31. apply to identified job openings using offline /online methods as per requirement	-	-	-	-
PC32. answer questions politely, with clarity and confidence, during recruitment and selection	-	-	-	-
PC33. identify apprenticeship opportunities and register for it as per guidelines and requirements	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	20	30	-	-

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	DGT/VSQ/N0102
NOS Name	Employability Skills (60 Hours)
Sector	Cross Sectoral
Sub-Sector	Professional Skills
Occupation	Employability
NSQF Level	4
Credits	2
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	18/02/2025
Next Review Date	18/02/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	18/02/2025

Assessment Guidelines and Assessment Weightage

Assessment Guidelines

Written Test

This will comprise:

(i) True / False Statements

(ii) Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

The written test is used to assess the candidate's theoretical understanding of agri-value addition, market dynamics, sustainability practices, logistics, and business formation processes.

Practical Test



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This will involve real-life assignments based on NOS-related project briefs. Candidates will perform specific tasks using the required tools, documentation, and processes. The assessor will observe technical execution, accuracy, decision-making, quality awareness, and adherence to sustainable practices.

Structured Interview (Viva)

This will assess the candidate's conceptual clarity, logical reasoning, problem-solving ability, communication skills, and behavioral traits. It also evaluates the ability to interpret practical results, align with business goals, and reflect workplace readiness.

Theory component will cover:

- Sustainable seed and pesticide selection based on market trends and agro-climatic zones.
- Agri-value chain components, mapping, and development analysis.
- Warehousing processes, storage norms, and logistics documentation.
- Legal, operational, and structural aspects of Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs).
- Workplace health, hygiene, safety standards, and employability skills like communication and digital literacy.

Practical component will cover:

- Advising farmers using sample data and market intelligence.
- Designing or analyzing a value chain using case studies.
- Simulating warehousing tasks like stock entry, quality grading, and inventory tracking.
- Conducting stakeholder mapping or forming mock FPO structures.
- Demonstrating correct use of safety gear, hygiene practices, or effective communication in a work scenario.

Viva session will cover:

- Justify seed or pesticide recommendations.
- Explain decisions taken during value chain optimization.
- Describe warehouse compliance practices.



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- Clarify the functions and benefits of FPOs.
- Articulate personal employability strengths, digital skills, and team behavior

Minimum Passing Criteria

- 70% overall score required to pass.
- Minimum 70% score required in each NOS

Reassessment Policy

- Candidates who fail to clear the assessment will get one reassessment opportunity to appear the assessment.
- Reassessment must be conducted after additional remedial training in the failed NOS.

Assessor Requirements

- Must be a ToA (Training of Assessors) Certified Assessor.
- Should be trained in assessment methodology, NSQF guidelines, and sector-specific evaluation standards.

Minimum Aggregate Passing % at QP Level : 70

(Please note: Every Trainee should score a minimum aggregate passing percentage as specified above, to successfully clear the Qualification Pack assessment.)

Minimum Passing % at NOS Level: 70

(Please note: A Trainee must score the minimum percentage for each NOS separately as well as on the QP as a whole.)

Assessment Weightage

Compulsory NOS



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National Occupational Standards	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks	Total Marks	Weightage
CUTM/AGR/N0301.Suggest Farmers for Sustainable Seeds, Pesticides based on the Market Conditions	30	40	-	30	100	20
CUTM/AGR/N0302.Value Chain Developer and Analyst	40	60	-	-	100	20
CUTM/AGR/N0303.Study of Agri-Warehouse Operations	40	60	-	-	100	20
CUTM/AGR/N0304.Study and Analysis of the Formation and Operations of the Farmer Producer Organizations	30	70	-	-	100	15
CUTM/VSQ/N7802.Apply Health and Safety at Workplace	30	40	-	30	100	15
DGT/VSQ/N0102.Employability Skills (60 Hours)	20	30	-	-	50	10
Total	190	300	-	60	550	100



Qualification Pack

Acronyms

NOS	National Occupational Standard(s)
NSQF	National Skills Qualifications Framework
QP	Qualifications Pack
TVET	Technical and Vocational Education and Training

Qualification Pack

Glossary

Sector	Sector is a conglomeration of different business operations having similar business and interests. It may also be defined as a distinct subset of the economy whose components share similar characteristics and interests.
Sub-sector	Sub-sector is derived from a further breakdown based on the characteristics and interests of its components.
Occupation	Occupation is a set of job roles, which perform similar/ related set of functions in an industry.
Job role	Job role defines a unique set of functions that together form a unique employment opportunity in an organisation.
Occupational Standards (OS)	OS specify the standards of performance an individual must achieve when carrying out a function in the workplace, together with the Knowledge and Understanding (KU) they need to meet that standard consistently. Occupational Standards are applicable both in the Indian and global contexts.
Performance Criteria (PC)	Performance Criteria (PC) are statements that together specify the standard of performance required when carrying out a task.
National Occupational Standards (NOS)	NOS are occupational standards which apply uniquely in the Indian context.
Qualifications Pack (QP)	QP comprises the set of OS, together with the educational, training and other criteria required to perform a job role. A QP is assigned a unique qualifications pack code.
Unit Code	Unit code is a unique identifier for an Occupational Standard, which is denoted by an 'N'
Unit Title	Unit title gives a clear overall statement about what the incumbent should be able to do.
Description	Description gives a short summary of the unit content. This would be helpful to anyone searching on a database to verify that this is the appropriate OS they are looking for.
Scope	Scope is a set of statements specifying the range of variables that an individual may have to deal with in carrying out the function which have a critical impact on quality of performance required.

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Knowledge and Understanding (KU)	Knowledge and Understanding (KU) are statements which together specify the technical, generic, professional and organisational specific knowledge that an individual needs in order to perform to the required standard.
Organisational Context	Organisational context includes the way the organisation is structured and how it operates, including the extent of operative knowledge managers have of their relevant areas of responsibility.
Technical Knowledge	Technical knowledge is the specific knowledge needed to accomplish specific designated responsibilities.
Core Skills/ Generic Skills (GS)	Core skills or Generic Skills (GS) are a group of skills that are the key to learning and working in today's world. These skills are typically needed in any work environment in today's world. These skills are typically needed in any work environment. In the context of the OS, these include communication related skills that are applicable to most job roles.
Electives	Electives are NOS/set of NOS that are identified by the sector as contributive to specialization in a job role. There may be multiple electives within a QP for each specialized job role. Trainees must select at least one elective for the successful completion of a QP with Electives.
Options	Options are NOS/set of NOS that are identified by the sector as additional skills. There may be multiple options within a QP. It is not mandatory to select any of the options to complete a QP with Options.